

Lost partition

Q I have Intel Celeron 1.7 GHz processor, with 128 DDR RAM and a 40 GB hard disk, running Windows 98 and XP. The problem is that when I boot my system into Windows XP, it shows four partitions. However, when I boot into Windows 98, it just shows three partitions. It omits the partition in which Windows XP is installed. What should I do?

Soman Dubey

A Soman, you will need to purchase a utility called Paragon NTFS for Windows 98 (http://www.paragongmbh.com/n_ntfs.htm), which will mount the Windows XP NTFS partition in Windows 98. Alternatively, you can re-install Windows XP and convert the partition into FAT32.

What's the name again?

Q I installed Red Hat Linux 8.0 on my pc. While installing, I was asked to enter root password, I entered it as 'mahendra'. Then I was asked to make users, but I didn't. Now when I boot my PC, I am asked to enter username and password, since I had not created any user. What should I do?

Mahendra

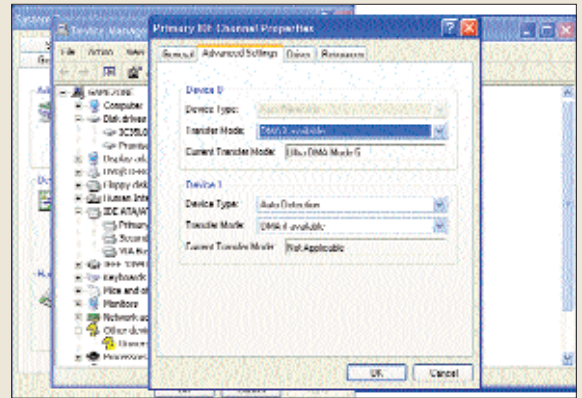
A Don't worry, Linux always creates a root user that acts as the administrator of the computer. Simply enter 'root' as the username, and 'mahendra' as the password.

Where is DMA?

Q I use the Parashar Jyotish software, but when I try to print a page it shows box like characters, instead of actual font. I have installed the software in all the versions of Windows—Me, 98, 2000 and XP. I am yet to find a solution. Can you help me? Also, I want to know where the DMA option is located in Windows XP.

Krishn Kant Pandey

A To access the DMA option in Windows XP, go to the Control Panel and double-click on System. Go to Hardware and click on Device Manager. Double-click on the 'IDE ATA/ATAPI Controllers' category, and then double-click on 'Primary IDE Channel' to



Access the DMA settings in the Advanced Settings tab

bring up the Properties sheet. In the Advanced Settings tab, you'll find the necessary settings. Access the DMA settings for 'Secondary IDE Channel' in the same manner.

Regarding your problems with the printout, it is program plus printer specific. Most likely, the program uses a font that the printer doesn't support. Check the printer's Web site for updated drivers. Alternatively, you may contact the software manufacturer to check if they have a software update for the application.

A The fault, Gurpreet, lies with your graphics card's drivers. An incorrectly installed driver can cause this problem. You haven't specified your system configuration, so you'll have to locate your manufacturer's Web site and download the latest drivers for your operating system from there.

Buying a RAM

Q I have a Compaq system Celeron 333 MHz, with 64 MB SD RAM and Windows Me. My computer is very slow, so I have decided to increase the RAM. Are there any technical specifications that I have to note before buying the RAM? I'm not sure about my motherboard, but I found (using Dr.Hardware), that my motherboard uses the Intel 440EX PCI chipset.

Vinay Nair

A The specifications you need to keep in mind are the RAM type and its speed. In your case, the type is SDRAM, the speed could be 66 MHz or 100 MHz. Look for a 100 MHz module for the upgrade. In case you decide to keep your old stick, remem-

ber to buy the same speed RAM or else system conflicts will occur. You can buy RAM on a testing warranty basis to check for system compatibility.

Who came first? Master or slave

Q I have a Pentium III 1.13 GHz machine running Windows 98 SE and Windows XP. My hard disk is connected as secondary master. When I connect another hard disk to my PC (as secondary slave), it does not boot from my secondary master hard disk, and boots from secondary the slave instead. CMOS setting shows first boot device as HDD0. Please give me a solution.

Pradeep Gade

A First, connect the hard drive that has your operating system to the primary IDE channel, and configure it as your primary master. Next, connect the other drive to the secondary channel and configure it as a secondary slave. This will solve your problem.

Dreaded blue screen plague

Q I have a Pentium IV with Windows XP

Professional and 512 MB RAM. For months now, I have been plagued with a recurring problem that leaves me frustrated. Every now and then, my PC crashes, leaving me with the dreaded blue screen saying, "A problem has been detected and Windows has been shut down to prevent damage to your computer". This is followed by some generic advice about how to fix the problem. Further, two important things that show up are: a program called win32k.sys along with a memory address, and second, 'IRQL_NOT_LESS_OR_EQUAL'. How can I fix this problem?

Mark

A The problem can occur due to reasons, such as incompatible hardware or software, or a conflicting device driver. Pin-pointing the exact cause is difficult since you have not mentioned the exact error message. However, you can visit http://www.microsoft.com/technet/treeview/default.asp?url=/technet/prodtechnol/winxp/presskit/prmd_stp_hwpag.asp for the detailed steps to help you diagnose and rectify the problem.